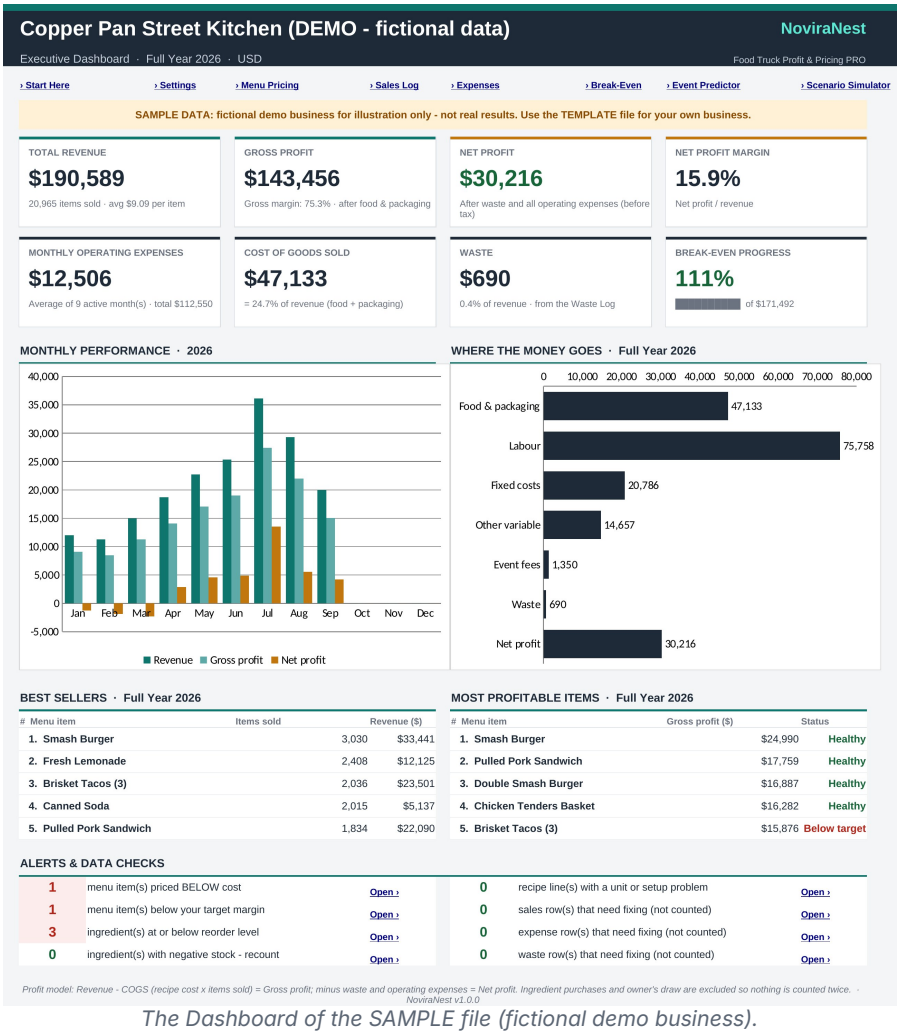
NOVIRANEST

Quick-Start Guide

Food Truck Profit & Pricing System PRO
Set up in about 30 minutes. No spreadsheet experience needed.



The Dashboard of the SAMPLE file (fictional demo business).

Version 1.0.0 · 2026-10-26 · For Microsoft Excel and Google Sheets

1. Which file do I open?

File	Use it for
..._TEMPLATE.xlsx	Your own business. Every log is empty. Start here.
..._SAMPLE.xlsx	Exploring. A fictional demo truck with nine months of made-up data so you can see every feature working. Its numbers are not real results or benchmarks.

Opening in Microsoft Excel

- Double-click the file. If Excel shows Protected View or Enable Editing, click Enable Editing (the file has no macros).
- Save a copy with your business name: File › Save As.

Opening in Google Sheets

- Go to drive.google.com › New › File upload and choose the TEMPLATE .xlsx.
- Open it, then choose File › Save as Google Sheets. Work in the new Google Sheets copy.
- Alternatively: in Google Sheets, File › Import › Upload and choose Replace spreadsheet.
- See section 6 for the small differences you will notice in Google Sheets.

What the colours mean

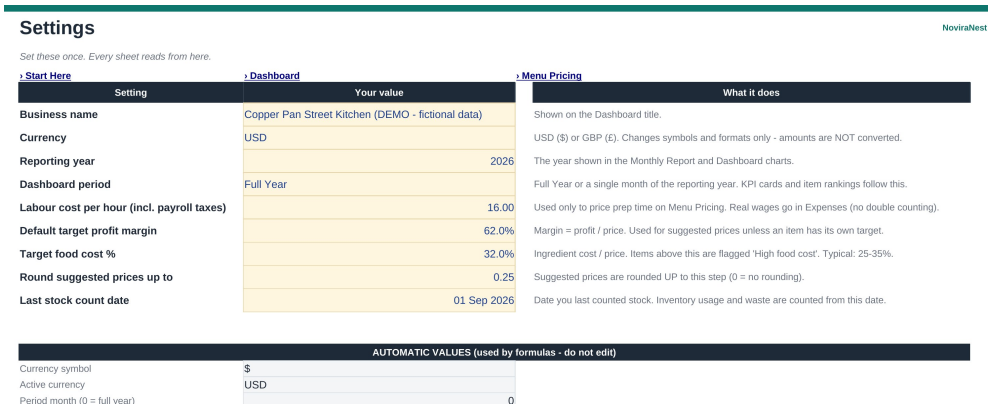
Colour	Meaning
Cream cell, blue text	Type here. The only cells you need to fill in.
Grey cell	Automatic formula. Please don't type over it.
Red / pink	Needs attention: loss-making item, unit mismatch, a row with a problem.
Blue box	Instructions.

Tip: every sheet has navigation links under its title (› Start Here, › Dashboard...). The Start Here sheet inside the workbook repeats this guide in short form.

2. Set up in six steps

Step 1 · Settings

- Business name - shown on the Dashboard.
- Currency - USD ($) or GBP (£). Only symbols change; amounts are never converted.
- Reporting year and Dashboard period (Full Year or one month).
- Labour cost per hour - used only to price prep time on menu items.
- Target profit margin (e.g. 60%) and Target food cost % (e.g. 30%).
- Round suggested prices up to - e.g. 0.25 gives prices like 9.25, 9.50.
- Last stock count date - leave blank until you do your first stock count.



Settings NoviraNest

Set these once. Every sheet reads from here.

› Start Here › Dashboard › Menu Pricing

Setting	Your value	What it does
Business name	Copper Pan Street Kitchen (DEMO - fictional data)	Shown on the Dashboard title.
Currency	USD	USD ($) or GBP (£). Changes symbols and formats only - amounts are NOT converted.
Reporting year	2026	The year shown in the Monthly Report and Dashboard charts.
Dashboard period	Full Year	Full Year or a single month of the reporting year. KPI cards and item rankings follow this.
Labour cost per hour (incl. payroll taxes)	16.00	Used only to price prep time on Menu Pricing. Real wages go in Expenses (no double counting).
Default target profit margin	62.0%	Margin = profit / price. Used for suggested prices unless an item has its own target.
Target food cost %	32.0%	Ingredient cost / price. Items above this are flagged 'High food cost'. Typical: 25-35%.
Round suggested prices up to	0.25	Suggested prices are rounded UP to this step (0 = no rounding).
Last stock count date	01 Sep 2026	Date you last counted stock. Inventory usage and waste are counted from this date.

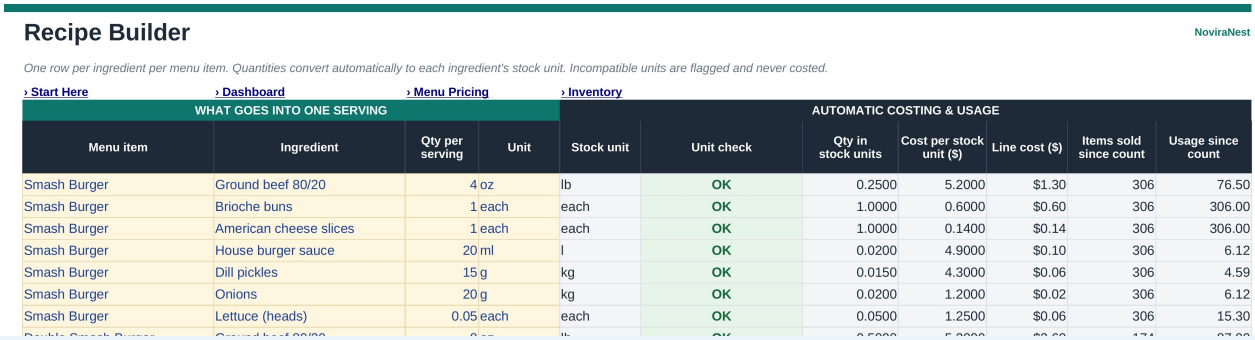
AUTOMATIC VALUES (used by formulas - do not edit)	
Currency symbol	$
Active currency	USD
Period month (0 = full year)	0

Step 2 · Inventory - your ingredients

- One row per ingredient. Pick the stock unit you count it in (kg, lb, each, l, gal...).
- Pack size = how many stock units in one pack you buy (a 10 lb case → 10). Pack price = what you pay.
- Cost per stock unit is calculated for you.
- Optional now, useful later: opening stock, purchases since count, reorder level.

Step 3 · Menu item names, then the Recipe Builder

- On Menu Pricing, type your menu item names in column B (one per row).
- On Recipe Builder, add one row for each ingredient in ONE serving: menu item, ingredient, quantity, unit.
- You can use any unit of the same type as the ingredient's stock unit: stock in lb, recipe in oz; stock in l, recipe in ml or tbsp.
- If the units cannot be converted (e.g. 'each' and 'g'), the row shows Unit mismatch in red and is not costed. Weight ↔ volume conversions are never guessed.



Recipe Builder NoviraNest

One row per ingredient per menu item. Quantities convert automatically to each ingredient's stock unit. Incompatible units are flagged and never costed.

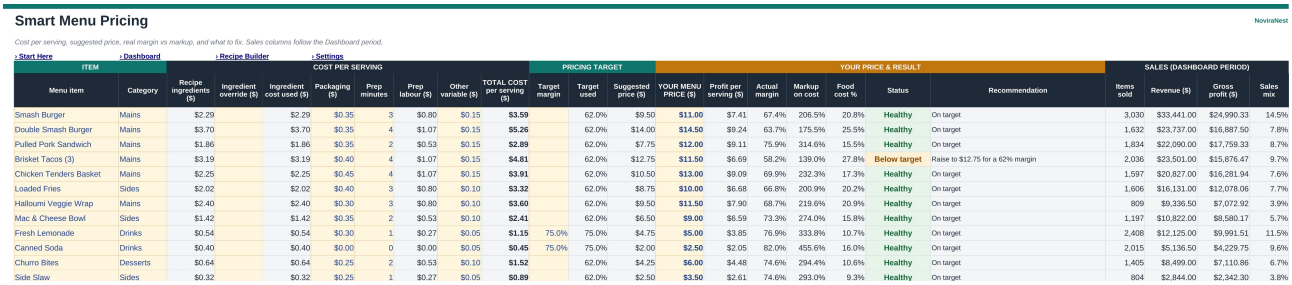
› Start Here › Dashboard › Menu Pricing › Inventory

WHAT GOES INTO ONE SERVING				AUTOMATIC COSTING & USAGE						
Menu item	Ingredient	Qty per serving	Unit	Stock unit	Unit check	Qty in stock units	Cost per stock unit ($)	Line cost ($)	Items sold since count	Usage since count
Smash Burger	Ground beef 80/20	4	oz	lb	OK	0.2500	5.2000	$1.30	306	76.50
Smash Burger	Brioche buns	1	each	each	OK	1.0000	0.6000	$0.60	306	306.00
Smash Burger	American cheese slices	1	each	each	OK	1.0000	0.1400	$0.14	306	306.00
Smash Burger	House burger sauce	20	ml	l	OK	0.0200	4.9000	$0.10	306	6.12
Smash Burger	Dill pickles	15	g	kg	OK	0.0150	4.3000	$0.06	306	4.59
Smash Burger	Onions	20	g	kg	OK	0.0200	1.2000	$0.02	306	6.12
Smash Burger	Lettuce (heads)	0.05	each	each	OK	0.0500	1.2500	$0.06	306	15.30

Short on time? Skip recipes and type an Ingredient override (cost per serving) directly on Menu Pricing. You can build recipes later. Inventory usage is only tracked for items with recipes.

Step 4 · Menu Pricing

- Add packaging, prep minutes, other variable cost per serving and your menu price.
- Read the result: suggested price, profit per serving, margin (profit ÷ price), markup (profit ÷ cost), food cost % and a status with a recommendation.
- Status meanings: LOSS (price below cost) · Below target margin · High food cost · Healthy.



Smart Menu Pricing

NoviraNest

Cost per serving, suggested price, real margin vs markup, and what to fix. Sales columns follow the Dashboard period.

› Start Here › Dashboard › Recipe Builder › Settings

ITEM		COST PER SERVING								PRICING TARGET			YOUR PRICE & RESULT						SALES (DASHBOARD PERIOD)			
Menu item	Category	Recipe ingredients ($)	Ingredient override ($)	Ingredient cost used ($)	Packaging ($)	Prep minutes	Prep labour ($)	Other variable ($)	TOTAL COST per serving ($)	Target margin	Target used	Suggested price ($)	YOUR MENU PRICE ($)	Profit per serving ($)	Actual margin	Markup on cost	Food cost %	Status	Recommendation	Items sold	Revenue ($)	Gross profit ($)	Sales mix
Smash Burger	Mains	$2.29		$2.29	$0.35	3	$0.80	$0.15	**$3.59**		62.0%	$9.50	**$11.00**	$7.41	67.4%	206.5%	20.8%	Healthy	On target	3,030	$33,441.00	$24,990.33	14.5%
Double Smash Burger	Mains	$3.70		$3.70	$0.35	4	$1.07	$0.15	**$5.26**		62.0%	$14.00	**$14.50**	$9.24	63.7%	175.5%	25.5%	Healthy	On target	1,632	$23,737.00	$16,887.50	7.8%
Pulled Pork Sandwich	Mains	$1.86		$1.86	$0.35	2	$0.53	$0.15	**$2.89**		62.0%	$7.75	**$12.00**	$9.11	75.9%	314.6%	15.5%	Healthy	On target	1,834	$22,090.00	$17,759.33	8.7%
Brisket Tacos (3)	Mains	$3.19		$3.19	$0.40	4	$1.07	$0.15	**$4.81**		62.0%	$12.75	**$11.50**	$6.69	58.2%	139.0%	27.8%	Below target	Raise to $12.75 for a 62% margin	2,036	$23,501.00	$15,876.47	9.7%
Chicken Tenders Basket	Mains	$2.25		$2.25	$0.45	4	$1.07	$0.15	**$3.91**		62.0%	$10.50	**$13.00**	$9.09	69.9%	232.3%	17.3%	Healthy	On target	1,597	$20,827.00	$16,281.94	7.6%
Loaded Fries	Sides	$2.02		$2.02	$0.40	3	$0.80	$0.10	**$3.32**		62.0%	$8.75	**$10.00**	$6.68	66.8%	200.9%	20.2%	Healthy	On target	1,606	$16,131.00	$12,078.06	7.7%
Halloumi Veggie Wrap	Mains	$2.40		$2.40	$0.30	3	$0.80	$0.10	**$3.60**		62.0%	$9.50	**$11.50**	$7.90	68.7%	219.6%	20.9%	Healthy	On target	809	$9,336.50	$7,072.92	3.9%
Mac & Cheese Bowl	Sides	$1.42		$1.42	$0.35	2	$0.53	$0.10	**$2.41**		62.0%	$6.50	**$9.00**	$6.59	73.3%	274.0%	15.8%	Healthy	On target	1,197	$10,822.00	$8,580.17	5.7%
Fresh Lemonade	Drinks	$0.54		$0.54	$0.30	1	$0.27	$0.05	**$1.15**	75.0%	75.0%	$4.75	**$5.00**	$3.85	76.9%	333.8%	10.7%	Healthy	On target	2,408	$12,125.00	$9,991.51	11.5%
Canned Soda	Drinks	$0.40		$0.40	$0.00	0	$0.00	$0.05	**$0.45**	75.0%	75.0%	$2.00	**$2.50**	$2.05	82.0%	455.6%	16.0%	Healthy	On target	2,015	$5,136.50	$4,229.75	9.6%
Churro Bites	Desserts	$0.64		$0.64	$0.25	2	$0.53	$0.10	**$1.52**		62.0%	$4.25	**$6.00**	$4.48	74.6%	294.4%	10.6%	Healthy	On target	1,405	$8,499.00	$7,110.86	6.7%
Side Slaw	Sides	$0.32		$0.32	$0.25	1	$0.27	$0.05	**$0.89**		62.0%	$2.50	**$3.50**	$2.61	74.6%	293.0%	9.3%	Healthy	On target	804	$2,844.00	$2,342.30	3.8%

Menu Pricing in the SAMPLE file.

Step 5 · Break-Even budget

- On Break-Even, type the monthly costs that do not change with each item sold: rent/commissary, truck payment, insurance, permits (monthly share), planned wages, typical fuel.
- Do not include ingredients or packaging - they are already in the cost per item.
- Optionally type the % of sales lost to card fees or commissions, your trading days per month and a profit goal.

Step 6 · Start logging

Sheet	When	What to enter
Sales Log	Daily (or per event)	Date, menu item, quantity. Price charged only if different from the menu price. Location/event name if you want event reports.
Expenses	When you pay	Date, category, amount. Ingredient purchases and owner's draw can be logged - they are kept for your records but excluded from profit.
Waste Log	When you throw food away	Date, ingredient, quantity and unit, reason.

Rows with a red Check are not counted until fixed. The Dashboard's Alerts & data checks panel tells you how many rows need attention.

3. Reading the Dashboard



Card	What it means
Total revenue	Items sold × price charged, for the Dashboard period.
Gross profit	Revenue − cost of goods sold (ingredients + packaging + other variable cost). Labour is not in COGS.
Net profit	Gross profit − waste − operating expenses. Before income tax.
Net profit margin	Net profit ÷ revenue.
Monthly operating expenses	For a month period: that month. For the full year: average per month with activity.
Waste	Value of food logged on the Waste Log.
Break-even progress	Revenue ÷ break-even revenue for the period (needs Step 5).

Switch Settings › Dashboard period to a month to see that month's cards and best sellers. The monthly chart always shows the full reporting year.

4. Planning tools

Event Profit Predictor

- Enter attendance, % of people who buy, orders per customer and average order value for worst / base / best case.
- Enter the event's costs once: pitch fee, commission %, card %, food cost %, staff, hours, wage, travel, fuel, other.
- Read estimated profit, break-even orders, break-even attendance and the risk verdict.
- After the event, log its sales with Location = the exact event name. Actual revenue, items and COGS appear automatically. Type the actual costs to see actual profit vs forecast.
- Forecasts never feed the Dashboard. Enter real event costs on Expenses so they count in your monthly profit.

Scenario Simulator

- The baseline is your average month from the Sales Log and Expenses (or type your own baseline).
- Pick a preset (ingredient inflation, price increase, busy/slow season, wage rise, event fees, perfect storm) or choose Custom and type your own % changes.
- See revenue, gross profit, net profit and break-even change - and the average price needed to keep today's profit. Nothing on your other sheets changes.

Break-Even Calculator

- Contribution per item = average price − average item cost − % fees.
- Break-even items = monthly fixed costs ÷ contribution per item (rounded up).
- Margin of safety compares your actual average items per month with break-even.

5. Your routine

How often	Task	Time
Daily	Log sales (one row per item per day is enough).	2-5 min
Weekly	Log expenses and waste. Glance at Dashboard alerts.	10 min
When supplier prices change	Update pack price on Inventory. Menu costs, suggested prices and statuses update.	2 min
Monthly	Review the Dashboard and Monthly Report. Check items marked Below target / LOSS.	15 min
Stock count	See below.	30 min

Doing a stock count

- Count what you have. On Inventory, type the counted amounts into Opening stock at count.
- Clear Purchased since count and Other usage (set to 0).
- In Settings, set Last stock count date to the count date.
- From then on, usage from sales and waste after that date is deducted automatically. Add deliveries to Purchased since count as they arrive.

Need more rows?

Logs come pre-built with 3,000 sales rows, 1,500 expense rows, 500 waste rows, 400 recipe lines, 100 ingredients and 50 menu items. At one row per item per day, 3,000 sales rows cover roughly a year for a 10-item menu. Start a new copy of the TEMPLATE each year (recommended), or insert rows inside a table (not below it) so formulas and ranges extend automatically - then copy a formula row into the new rows.

6. Google Sheets notes

The workbook was designed for both apps and avoids Excel-only functions. When opened in Google Sheets:

- Currency symbols: in Excel, money cells show $ or £. Google Sheets cannot change number formats conditionally, so money cells show plain numbers; the currency symbol appears in column headers and on all Dashboard cards. Switching USD/GBP still works.
- Charts are converted by Google and may look slightly different (colours, label positions).
- Navigation links between sheets may need a click on the sheet tab instead if a link does not jump.
- Protected Dashboard: Google may show a warning if you try to edit it - that is intended.
- Dropdowns, input messages, formulas and conditional colours work the same way.
- Dates and numbers follow your Google account's locale (File › Settings).

7. Troubleshooting

You see...	Do this
Check: Item not on Menu Pricing	Spelling must match exactly. Use the dropdown.
Check: Enter a valid date	Type a real date in your computer's date format, e.g. 15/03/2026 (UK) or 3/15/2026 (US).
Unit check: Unit mismatch	Pick a unit of the same type as the ingredient's stock unit (mass, volume or count).
Status: Add costs	Build the recipe or type an ingredient override for the item.
Inventory: Recount (negative)	Usage exceeded stock: do a stock count (section 5) or add missing purchases.
Dashboard all zeros	Check Settings › Reporting year matches your sales dates.
Break-even progress shows Set up	Enter monthly fixed costs on Break-Even.

This workbook gives management estimates. It is not tax, legal or accounting advice. Keep your official records with your accountant or bookkeeping software.

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